and its policy toward that country would move closer to those of the US. There were changes in Washington too—not on the question of whether China was a threat, but in the kind of threat that it posed and in the means considered best to tackle it. This US-India convergence on China not only implicitly eased the strains between the two democracies but also explicitly brought them together.

Washington had growing concerns about both the security threat and the ideological challenge that China posed. Likewise, the Indian leadership increasingly saw China as a traditional security threat as well as a symbolic one. Moreover, the US and India agreed on what was required to contain and confront such a threat: close partnership with each other, and the strengthening of India's development effort and eventually its defense apparatus.

Between 1956 and 1958, Eisenhower came around in part to Nehru's view of the threat from communism and China. His administration worried that along with communist infiltration of individuals, the infiltration of ideas and influence could be threatening. Washington watched the battlefield for hearts, minds, and stomachs unfold beyond Europe through a Cold War lens. It would be a victory for communism if Soviet-backed China succeeded while India failed economically. But if the US helped India win the development race versus China, it could demonstrate to the uncommitted world that democracy and development could coexist and thrive.

Simultaneously, Nehru started to worry about the threat of the infiltration of individuals and influence from China. There was growing concern about China's attitude toward the Sino-Indian border, Chinese behavior in Tibet, and Beijing's increasing interactions with India's neighbors. Delhi had growing doubts about China's commitment to peaceful coexistence and noninterference. Furthermore, Nehru was anxious that China might demonstrate that its approach—rather than democratic India's—was more successful at delivering the goods to its people. Between 1956 and 1958, his government dealt with charges of complacency and stagnation while China seemed to thrive next door and communism established an official foothold within India. Nehru's government had to kick-start the economy, but this task was near impossible without external assistance, especially from the US.